

meesho

SEASON 3

DICE CHALLENGE

BUILDING MEESHO
CONSUMER-TO-
MANUFACTURER
(C2M) BASE

**BUSINESS
TRACK**

The Landscape in India

India has one of the largest manufacturing bases in the world, spanning apparel, footwear, home goods, personal care, and more. Yet most manufacturers sell through long, intermediary-heavy chains, distributors, wholesalers, and resellers, before a product ever reaches an online buyer. Each layer adds margin, and therefore price.

Marketplaces have started sourcing more directly from manufacturers who own a meaningful part of their value chain, such as raw material, production, scale, and automation, and can therefore offer structurally lower prices, not just discounted ones .

For Meesho, whose core promise to buyers is the lowest price, C2M is not a nice to have category play, it is a direct lever on the platform's central value proposition. Yet most large manufacturers today either stay offline entirely or sell through resellers on marketplaces, rather than listing directly.

C2M at Meesho

At Meesho, C2M refers to sourcing directly from manufacturers rather than through intermediaries or resellers. Meesho already works with a small base of such manufacturers today, across categories like apparel, home goods, and personal care, sourced from manufacturing hubs across the country.

The premise is straightforward: manufacturers who own a meaningful part of their own value chain, whether through raw material, production, scale, or automation, should be able to offer a real price advantage over sellers who are simply reselling someone else's product. In practice, this advantage does not show up uniformly. Seller scale is often used as a starting signal for who might have this advantage, but scale alone does not always translate into a lower price on the platform.

Despite the potential upside to Meesho's affordability promise, C2M penetration on the platform today remains low. Most large manufacturers either stay offline entirely or continue to sell through intermediaries on other marketplaces, rather than listing directly with Meesho.

Objective

"Design a strategy to meaningfully grow Meesho's C2M seller base and their long-term contribution to price competitiveness."

This is fundamentally two connected problems, not one. First, most large manufacturers don't come onto B2C e-commerce at all. Their businesses are built around bulk, made to order B2B operations with no returns, and shifting to unit-led B2C means new operations, inventory risk, and a real cost of failure if it doesn't work. Second, even manufacturers who do onboard often don't stick around. Early order volumes are weak, conviction erodes fast, and they exit before the channel becomes meaningful for them.

A strategy that solves only one side, attracting manufacturers without a credible plan to retain them, or retaining a handful through effort that can't be repeated at scale, will not move the needle for Meesho.

Expected Benefits

- **For manufacturers:** A new demand channel and better capacity utilisation, without having to abandon their core B2B business.
- **For buyers:** Structurally lower prices on products where real cost advantages exist, not just discounts.
- **For the platform:** A durable, defensible source of price competitiveness that strengthens Meesho's core value proposition and compounds over time.

Challenges

- **Operational hassle:** Large manufacturers are built for bulk dispatch with zero returns. Single order processing, packing, and reverse logistics are entirely new capabilities they don't have and are reluctant to build.
- **Inventory risk:** B2C requires pre stocking inventory against uncertain demand, a fundamentally different risk model from demand confirmed B2B manufacturing, where nothing is made until it's already sold.
- **Unproven demand:** Manufacturers who are willing to try get stuck on one question, will there be enough scale to justify the shift? An unquantified promise isn't enough.

- **Weak early scale-up:** Newly onboarded sellers today capture only a small share of orders in their first 30 days, which erodes seller confidence before the channel has a real chance to prove itself.

Required Output

Your strategy should answer:

- Which manufacturer segments and categories offer a genuine, defensible price advantage, and which don't, despite scale?
- What is stopping reluctant manufacturers from coming onto Meesho, and what would credibly change their calculus?
- Once onboarded, what makes early scale-up sustainable, without depending on subsidies or manual handholding that can't scale to hundreds of sellers?
- What should Meesho measure to know if a C2M seller is on track to succeed, and when to intervene?

3-Slider Submission Round

- **Segment & Barrier Map:** Which manufacturer segments/categories to prioritise, and the top barriers preventing them from onboarding or scaling.
- **Prioritisation Framework:** How you'd rank levers across acquisition and scale-up.
- **Quick-Win Lever:** One lever you'd prioritise in your first 30 days, with a short rationale.

6–10 Slider Detailed Deck Submission

- **Manufacturer Segmentation:** By cohort (offline / online-active-elsewhere / previously churned from Meesho), their distinct barriers and motivations.
- **Market Sizing & Opportunity:** Scale of the addressable manufacturer base and the potential price/NMV impact of closing the gap.
- **Onboarding Model:** How you'd reduce entry barriers (e.g. support stack, risk-sharing, assisted operations) for reluctant manufacturers.
- **Sustainable Scale-Up Model:** How you'd drive early order conviction and retention in a way that scales to hundreds of sellers without unsustainable subsidy or manpower.

- **Metrics & KPIs:** What you'd track across onboarding, activation, and retention to know the model is working.
- **Roadmap:** A 30-60-90 day plan to pilot and then scale the approach.
- **Risks & Guardrails:** What could go wrong, and how you'd protect against it.

Evaluation Criteria

3-Slider Submission Round

1. Extent of Research - Methods, Sources, Coverage
2. Quality of Insights
3. User-First Approach
4. Problem-First Mindset

Detailed Deck Submission

1. Quality of Research - Methods, Sources, Coverage
2. Depth of Analysis
3. Innovativeness of Recommendations
4. 10x and Long-term Thinking
5. Feasibility of Implementation
6. Presentation Skills

Good luck! We look forward to seeing how you tackle this challenge and come up with innovative ideas for Meesho's growth and success.